

WARNING: EXTREME 10 LB Fat Loss Protocol

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Aug 02, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3Sd7lQOwBqE> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter lays out a complete 30-day fat-loss protocol — 20,000 daily steps, 2–4 full-body lifting sessions per week, a strict calorie and protein target tracked via AI, and four specific supplements including the GLP-1 peptide tirzepatide.

Contents

- 🎯 Protocol Overview & Mindset
- 🔥 How the Body Burns Calories (The Science)
- 🚶 Step 1 — Exercise: 20,000 Daily Steps
- 🏋️ Step 2 — Exercise: Weight Training
- 🍗 Step 3 — Diet: Calories & Protein Targets
- 📱 Tracking Calories with AI
- 💊 Supplement 1: Tirzepatide (GLP-1 Peptide)
- 💉 Supplement 2: Tesamorelin
- ☕ Supplements 3 & 4: Creatine & Caffeine
- 🗺️ Free Tool: The RIP Road Map

Protocol Overview & Mindset 0:03

- Goal: lose **10 pounds in 30 days** (~2.5 lbs/week)
- Carter frames this as "extreme but not my most extreme protocol" — deliberately designed to be the hardest most people can actually execute
- Three-part structure:
 - Exercise (walking + weight training)
 - Diet (calories + protein)
 - Supplements
- Standard disclaimer: Carter is not a doctor; consult your physician before following any of this advice, especially regarding supplements

How the Body Burns Calories (The Science) 2:20

- There are four distinct mechanisms by which your body burns calories:

- **BMR (Basal Metabolic Rate)** — accounts for 60–70% of total daily calorie burn; keeps organs running, blood pumping, breathing, etc.
- **Thermic Effect of Food (TEF)** — eating itself costs calories; responsible for about 5–15% of daily burn
 - Fat digestion burns ~0–3% of those calories
 - Carbohydrate digestion burns ~5% of those calories
 - Protein digestion burns **20–30%** of those calories — meaning you only absorb 70–80% of protein calories consumed
- **Exercise** — less impactful than most people assume; only ~8–10% of total daily calorie burn for active people
- **NEAT (Non-Exercise Activity Thermogenesis)** — movement outside of formal exercise (walking, fidgeting, household tasks); typically 15–30% of daily burn, but can be pushed higher than exercise-based burn
- Key insight: NEAT is more controllable and scalable than formal exercise, which is why walking is the cornerstone of this protocol

Step 1 — Exercise: 20,000 Daily Steps 1:56

- Target: **20,000 steps per day** (takes ~3 hours total, broken up throughout the day)
- Why walking beats intense cardio for fat loss:
 - Running a mile burns only ~100 calories on average — easily offset by a banana or handful of nuts
 - Intense cardio disrupts hunger hormones **leptin and ghrelin**, making you significantly hungrier afterward
 - Intense cardio triggers homeostasis: your body compensates by making you want to rest more and move less the rest of the day
 - Intense cardio is harder on joints (Carter, age 43, cites longevity and joint health as priorities)
 - Walking does NOT spike hunger hormones the same way
 - 20,000 steps burns **700–1,000 extra calories** for the average person

Walking 20,000 steps burns 7–10x more calories than running a mile, without triggering the hunger and recovery response that sabotages fat loss.

- Recommended daily step schedule (does NOT need to be consecutive):

Time	Walk Duration	Steps Earned
Morning (wake up)	30 min	~3,000
After breakfast	15 min	~1,500
After lunch	30 min	~3,000
Afternoon	15 min	~1,500
After dinner (with family)	45 min	~4,500

Time	Walk Duration	Steps Earned
Subtotal	2h 15min	~13,500

- Fill the remaining ~6,500 steps with lifestyle changes:
 - Skip the elevator; take the stairs
 - Park in the farthest spot instead of the closest
 - Walk to deliver messages at work instead of using Slack
 - Walk to get lunch instead of ordering Uber Eats
 - Pace while on phone calls
 - Clean the house, do chores while moving
 - Take a 10-minute walk every hour during an 8-hour office shift (~8,000 steps from that alone)

Step 2 — Exercise: Weight Training 8:08

- **2–4 full-body workouts per week** (minimum 2, up to 4)
- Structure per session:
 - Pick 1–2 exercises per body part
 - Do 2–3 sets per exercise
 - Rest only **60–90 seconds** between sets (timed strictly)
 - Total workout time: **45 minutes to 1 hour**
- Carter's personal method for timing rest:
 - Wears Apple Watch Ultra
 - After every set, raises wrist and says "Set, 90-second timer" — immediately starts the next set when it goes off
 - No phone scrolling, no chatting — noise-cancelling headphones on
- Purpose: preserve muscle mass during the calorie deficit; avoid looking "weak and frail"
- Carter has done full-body workouts exclusively for 11 years; has trained for 27 years total

Step 3 — Diet: Calories & Protein Targets 9:20

- **Calorie formula: current bodyweight (lbs) × 10 = daily calorie cap**
 - Example: 200 lb person → 2,000 calories/day
 - Always use *current* bodyweight, never goal bodyweight
 - Do not exceed this number for any reason
- **Protein formula: 1 gram of protein per pound of current bodyweight**
 - Example: 200 lb person → 200g protein/day minimum; more is better
 - Carter personally gets close to 300g/day and reports perfect bloodwork
 - Why so much protein:

- Thermic effect: body burns 20–30% of protein calories during digestion, so net calorie absorption is lower
- Preserves muscle mass during a deficit
- Prevents "Ozempic face" — the gaunt, frail look people get on GLP-1 drugs when they under-eat protein
- Note for heavier individuals (300 lb example): 300g protein/day is actually *advantageous* because most of those calories won't be fully absorbed; also, the fatter you are, the faster you'll lose fat — potentially more than 10 lbs in 30 days
- You MUST track calories — non-negotiable for hitting these targets

Tracking Calories with AI 13:47

- Recommended tools: **ChatGPT or Claude** (not Grok; Gemini may work)
- Method:
 - Use a specific prompt (available via link in video description) to start a dedicated tracking chat
 - Pin the chat so it's always accessible
 - Log each meal by typing what you ate or taking a photo of food labels
 - AI maintains a running calorie and macro total for the day
 - At night or at a restaurant, describe what's in your fridge/on the menu and ask the AI to suggest the best options to hit remaining targets
- **Claude advantage:** links with Apple Health, which syncs with the Oura Ring (worn 24/7) to show actual calories burned and real-time deficit throughout the day
- Carter used MyFitnessPal for over a decade but says this AI method is "way, way better"
- Prompts for both ChatGPT and Claude are linked in the video description

Supplement 1: Tirzepatide (GLP-1 Peptide) 16:45

- **Tirzepatide** — a GLP-1 peptide prescribed by a doctor; Carter calls it "the closest thing to a miracle supplement I've ever experienced"
- Effect: completely eliminates hunger and cravings
 - Carter: "I am not even thinking about food" while on it
 - Without tracking, there is "no way" he would have hit his 200g protein target accidentally
 - Analogy: dieting without a GLP-1 is like writing a report using the Dewey decimal system and a typewriter; dieting with tirzepatide is like using an iPad and Claude to write it instantly
- Benefits beyond appetite suppression:
 - Improved mental focus (not distracted by food thoughts)
 - Sleep quality improvement (see Tesamorelin section)
- **Critical warning:** because you won't feel hungry, you MUST track protein intentionally or you'll under-eat it and lose muscle — leading to the "Ozempic face" or frail appearance

- Why tirzepatide over retatrutide:
 - Retatrutide is not currently available via legitimate doctors
 - Carter declines to buy from unverified online sources
 - Retatrutide works on a different receptor that raises metabolic rate — some of Carter's friends experienced racing heart rates and had to stop
 - Tirzepatide worked without those side effects
- Carter's verdict: "I don't think I'll ever diet without a GLP again"

Supplement 2: Tesamorelin 20:14

- **Tesamorelin** — an FDA-approved peptide, prescription required
- Originally studied in HIV patients; proven in clinical trials to **reduce visceral fat, especially around the belly**
- Carter's personal experience:
 - Noticed visible difference in belly/abs area
 - Primary standout benefit: dramatically improved **sleep quality**
- Why sleep matters for fat loss:
 - Getting fewer than **6 hours of sleep** — even in a calorie deficit — causes the weight you lose to come disproportionately from **muscle** rather than fat due to hormonal disruption
 - Deep deficits can elevate cortisol at night, making sleep difficult
 - Tesamorelin (taken before bed) counteracts this: Carter describes it as "some of the best sleep I've ever had"

Supplements 3 & 4: Creatine & Caffeine 21:44

- **Creatine**
 - Carter recommends it for everyone, even non-exercisers
 - Benefits: muscle building, muscle preservation on a cut, cognitive function, mood boost (study-backed)
 - Bodybuilding/cutting dose: **5g/day** is sufficient
 - Carter personally takes ~20g/day to access additional cognitive and mood benefits that kick in above 5g
 - No need to cycle off — take indefinitely
 - Analogy: "your reliable friend" — steady, always there, helps build muscle, protects brain
- **Caffeine**
 - Benefits: energy (important when eating less), proven fat-burning effect
 - Especially useful for powering through the high daily step count on reduced calories
 - Carter's personal dose: **600–1,000 mg/day** (reduced from 1,000 mg after adding Mots-C peptide)
 - He stresses: do NOT copy his dose; he has been using it since his teens and recently had a clean EKG

- Synergy: creatine + caffeine work well together
- Analogy: "the friend you call when it's time to turn up"
- **Bonus mention — Mots-C peptide:**
 - Not directly a fat-loss supplement
 - Boosts mitochondrial function → increased energy
 - Since starting Mots-C, Carter reduced his caffeine intake from ~1,000 mg to ~600 mg/day because he no longer felt he needed as much



Free Tool: The RIP Road Map [24:04](#)

- Free AI-powered tool linked in the video description
- How it works:
 - Input your height, weight, and goal
 - Upload a photo of yourself
 - AI analyzes your body composition and estimates your body fat percentage
 - Outputs exact calorie and macro targets for your goal
 - Provides a week-by-week timeline of expected fat loss
- Designed to personalize the protocol from this video to your specific starting point